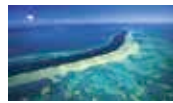




Cars as app platforms?

Fitbit for your car, developed by Automatic is designed to convert your car into an app platform.
<http://dgit.in/1FrejTQ>



Did you know?

At over 2000 kms long, the Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth!
<http://dgit.in/1IGIpVX>

numbers, lines and what not scattered all across the screen. I do have the original BIOS backup but I can't reflash it if I can't even enter my system BIOS, but the PC works fine when I remove the card and use the IGP. I hope there's a way to fix it and you guys can help me out, soon. Thanking you in advance.

—Ayush Bagchi

A Hey Ayush,

Let's hope that the overclock hasn't caused any irreparable damage to the video card's memory chips.

Try this approach:

1. Set the primary display adapter to the onboard chipset in the motherboard BIOS before plugging in your card.
2. Stick the HD5450 in and check if the computer boots up. If it does not, swap the graphics card to another PCI-E port and try again.
3. Open up a command prompt and list out all the adapters visible to ATIWinFlash (Use instructions available at <http://dgit.in/ATIWinF> and <http://dgit.in/ATIWinF2>)
4. Use the -pcie flag to do that.
5. Assuming you are able to see the adapter listed at a particular index, simply flash the old firmware onto the card at that index.
6. If you want, you can check if you still have write access to the graphics card's ROM using the -t flag.
7. If there are any mismatches then you can force the ROM flash process using the -f flag.
8. Let us know if it works out.

RAM Issues

Hi Team Digit,

I use an AMD based system with the following configuration:

- Processor: AMD FX-8350;
- Motherboard: MSI 970A-G43;
- RAM: G.Skill Ripjaws X 8GB (4 GBx2) 2133 MHz F3-17000CL11D-8GBXL;
- Storage: Samsung 840 500 GB SSD;
- GPU: Radeon HD 7770;
- OS: Windows 8

Previously I was using a 1333 MHz 8GB memory kit from Kingston on this PC and recently upgraded to the G.Skill RipjawsX kit mentioned above. I upgraded to this kit



SiSoft Sandra (Free Version) is a great PC benchmarking utility

because the frequency of this RAM is the maximum a MSI 970A-G43 motherboard can support.

Since I didn't know about any performance report finding software, I downloaded something called "PC Benchmark" from the Windows Store in order to check the performance of my PC after the RAM upgrade. However, what I found was that the score that I got using this software was lower as compared to the score I got with my old memory kit - a drop from 1,382.4 to 1,197.57.

I know that the task manager reports exactly half the frequency of the actual frequency and so I'm observing 1067 MHz which seems alright. I even saw a slight improvement in performance as some programs seemed to load faster than before. But what is the deal with this RAM

kit when it comes to the performance benchmark using that program?

Can you tell me whether something's wrong with this memory kit or not?

—Aneesh Prajapati

A Hi Aneesh,

Memory bandwidth is known to give results that may look fishy or different in synthetic benchmarks making you fuss over its performance. Different memory benchmarks give results differently and it's always advisable to use popular benchmarking tools that are known to all so that you can refer to results from others with similar hardware and compare scores accordingly.

SiSoft Sandra (free version) is a really good all-rounder benchmarking suite. Or, you can even use MaxxMEM² available here: <http://goo.gl/EDg2Wn>, which is also a nifty little memory benchmarking utility. Giving you an example about memory performance, Intel's new Haswell CPUs actually make quite some use of higher memory bandwidth which may be slightly visible in real world use and result in better performance.

In order to gain some peace of mind over this RAM issue, slot in your old Kingston memory modules and run SiSoft Sandra which has a variety of tests including synthetic memory benchmarks that will tell you accurate scores.

Compare results with both the kits and you'll see the difference. But, honestly, will the synthetic scores matter that much when it comes to translating that performance into real world applications?

This is somewhat difficult to say outside synthetic benchmarks and encoding. Although we have seen an improvement in performance when using higher frequency memory but this improvement was always in synthetic benchmarks and visible to a small degree in real world applications but it wasn't enough to justify paying a huge sum of money for faster RAM modules.

But with the changing CPU landscape, we'll see improvements steadily, as witnessed while using Haswell. As for your memory modules, they seem to be working absolutely fine and you can stop stressing over them now. **!**

